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I would like to strengthen my academic management by conquering chronic procrastination. As chronic procrastination is a trait that I have carried with me since primary school and the consequences of being overly sluggish with academic tasks can lead to severe psychological problems, acute anxiety and reduced academic performance (Sirois & Pychyl, 2013; Tice & Baumeister, 1997). In conclusion, it is important for me to beat procrastination and keep a systematic, initiative study habit as a way to improve myself.

Before setting up some goals to overcome procrastination, let's first talk about my own experiences and bad study habits. In my primary school, my parents have high expectations on my study results and very watchful on my homework. If I make little mistakes or not get full marks in the exam, I will be punished harshly, which make me very scared and anxious. In response to great family pressure, I gradually procrastinate my homework and study until the last moment so that I don't have to deal with the anxiety of doing something not perfect. Now that I look at my own childhood, I understand that the authoritarian parenting style of my parents caused my chronic procrastination. Authoritarian parents are very demanding and controlling. Such parents often produce apprehensive, stress-prone, and failure-fearful kids (Baumrind, 1971). Also, Wood (2013) pointed out that we are very influenced by our self-concept, in which our reflected appraisal (how we think significant others view and evaluate us) plays a significant role. I internalized the judgment of my parents. Therefore, I connected my self-worth to perfect marks. In that case, procrastinating is a way to guard my self-esteem. If I procrastinate, I can just attribute any bad results to not enough time, not to lack of ability. As a consequence, I keep reinforcing my external locus of control (Hanna et al., 2010).

I've not been making any airy-fairy promises. I've implemented a system of self-check which fits in with the "SMART" criteria in order to develop habits of studiousness and discourage spur-of-the-moment cramming in the next month.

As for the 'S' (specific) criterion, I will divide every coming assignment into three subtasks. Firstly, to analyse the question and think of ideas for the outline. Secondly, to create a rough draft for it. Thirdly, to finally proofread the draft. This exact focusing approach will help to reduce the pressure from massive academic workload. As for the 'M' (measurable) criterion, I will set a target of 6 hours of revision time for exam every week. Specifically, 2 hours each (7-9pm) on Tuesday, Thursday and Saturday. I will monitor my study progress through Yeolpumta app which would show me the length of time I study and the topics that I have covered. Meanwhile, I will try a set of past paper to measure my understanding level. Also, I will keep a note of my accuracy rate. if I drop below 70% in accuracy I'll really try to improve on that particular weak spot(s) in the next week or so... I will put more time in the next week to revise the topics which I was not well-performed in. As for the "A" (achievable) criterion, I will set up a quiet place at home to study for the regular revision time. Besides, Yeolpumta app has the app blocking function to prevent me from any digital distractions. Also, in order to make sure of my consistency. If there is an unavoidable event, I will re-schedule it to the next evening to keep my weekly dedication. As for the "R" (relevant) criterion, by planning my regular study schedule, it will reinforce the feeling of internal locus of control. Also, it will promote my positive self-concept. It demonstrates the importance of consistent personal effort for academic performance (Hanna et al., 2010). As for the "T" (time-bound) criterion, I will persistently keep my regular study plan for one month. I will reflect on the study progress on a weekly basis to make sure that I can develop my sustainable study habits instead of last-minute cramming.

In short, beating chronic procrastination with this kind of study plan is critical to maintain my academic competency and mental health. So I'm sure I can reach my goal. Hence, I am certain that I could make it happen.

(Word count: 599)

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